Experiment 4

Ex. No.: 4

Find Last Connected USB on Your System (USB Forensics)

Aim

To identify the most recently connected USB device on an authorised Windows system using USBDeview.

Tools required

1. Windows lab workstation or an authorised offline Windows installation.
2. USBDeview.
3. Administrator access when the lab requires device-management or remote-computer features.

Idea/Theory

1. Windows retains information about USB devices that are currently connected and devices seen earlier.
2. USBDeview presents fields such as device name, description, device type, serial number, first/last connection time, Vendor ID, and Product ID.
3. Connection records can support a timeline, but the examiner must account for time zone, clock accuracy, and devices that do not expose unique serial numbers.
4. Device disable, uninstall, or disconnect functions change system state and should not be used during evidence review.

Experiment 4 — continued

Procedure/Steps

1. Run USBDeview on the authorised lab system. If working remotely, use only the approved remote-computer and administrator credentials.
2. Refresh the device list and distinguish connected devices from historical entries.
3. Show the device description, type, serial number, connected state, first-added time, last plug/unplug time, Vendor ID, and Product ID columns.
4. Sort by the last plug/unplug field to locate the latest entry.
5. Record the identifying fields and time-zone context in the case notes; corroborate the entry with other Windows artefacts where required.
6. Export or capture the relevant rows during the supervised lab run without enabling, disabling, disconnecting, or uninstalling devices.

Observation/Output

Screenshots to be attached from the lab run (tool: USBDeview)

Result

To be completed after the lab run.